The Holiday Game Plan

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Submitted: [Date]

Project 1: Getting Into Breaking Games' Raw Data

1.1 Five instant answers

The questions Mike asks every Monday morning. For each one, paste your SQL query, the answer, and one sentence on whether the result surprised you or matched what you expected.

Q1: Top 10 products by units sold.

```
SELECT product_title, net_items_sold
FROM shopify_sales
ORDER BY net_items_sold DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

Answer:

	product_title	net_items_sold
1	Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY …	396
2	Dwellings of Eldervale - Oracle Hex…	392
3	We're Doomed!	370
4	Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur …	323
5	Dwellings of Eldervale - …	310
6	Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden …	296
7	MIXTAPE	254
8	Dwellings of Eldervale 2nd Edition:…	237
9	Holiday Insert 2025 Gift Tag	230
10	Holiday Bow 2025	230

Your reaction: I was surprised that most of the top 10 by units are Dwellings of Eldervale add-ons and holiday gift items rather than full games, which tells me unit volume alone could mislead Mike's reorder decisions.

Q2: Top 10 products by total revenue.

```
SELECT product_title, total_sales
FROM shopify_sales
ORDER BY total_sales DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

Answer:

	product_title	total_sales
1	Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY …	28190.64
2	Dwellings of Eldervale 2nd Edition:…	24342.13
3	We're Doomed!	13371.28
4	Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden …	5997.5
5	Expancity | Family Strategy City …	5983.09
6	Dwellings of Eldervale - DELUXE …	5529.72
7	MIXTAPE	5284.12
8	Klask (First Edition)	4939.05
9	Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur …	3274.07
10	Dwellings of Eldervale - …	3139.39

Your reaction: The revenue ranking mostly matched my expectations, with Dwellings at the top, but the Oracle Hex Tile is #2 by units and doesn't make the revenue top 10 at all, which shows money and volume tell different stories.

Q3: How many products are in the catalog?

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM shopify_sales;
```

Answer:

	COUNT(*)
1	116

Your reaction: The count of 116 matched what I'd seen since my first SELECT *, but I noticed many of those rows are upgrade kits, accessories, and gift add-ons, so the number of actual games is smaller.

Q4: What was the total Meta ad spend?

```
SELECT SUM(spend_usd) FROM meta_campaigns;
```

Answer:

	SUM(spend_usd)
1	98542.56

Your reaction: The $98,542.56 total was larger than I expected for an indie publisher, and I noticed meta_as_sets sums to the exact same amount, so adding both tables would have double-counted the spend.

Q5: How many unique checkout sessions started?

```
SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT name) FROM shopify_checkouts;
```

Answer:

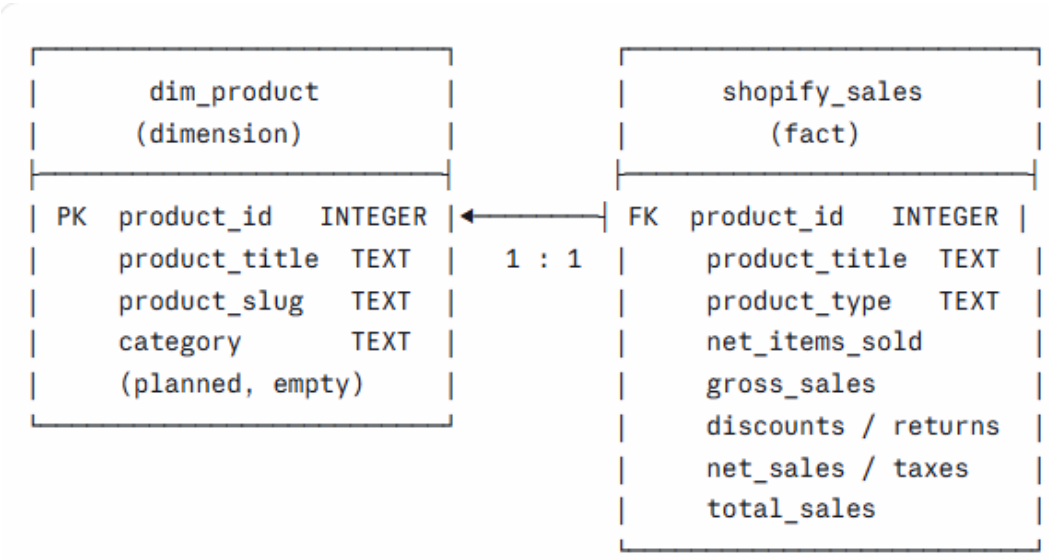
	COUNT(DISTINCT name)
1	1197

Your reaction: I didn't expect COUNT (*) to over-count by 382, which showed me that this table stores line items rather than sessions and that I need to check what a row represents before trusting a count.

Project 2: Designing Your First Database

2.1 Schema diagram

Paste or sketch your schema after building dim_product. Show the dimension table and which fact tables now connect to it through product_id.



The relationship is 1:1 for now because shopify_sales is already one row per product. When shopify_orders and shopify_checkouts are linked later, those relationships will be 1:many, since one product appears on many orders.

2.2 The dim_product design decision

Two or three sentences: which columns did you choose for dim_product, why, and what did you deliberately leave out?

I limited dim_product to attributes that describe what a product is and that stay the same from sale to sale: a synthetic product_id as a stable primary key, the title, a URL slug for matching to referral landing pages, and a planned category column for Strategy/Party/Family. I deliberately left out price, units, and revenue because they change with every sale, discount, and date, so they belong in the fact tables. I used a generated integer ID instead of the title because titles in this data have typos and variants. For example, the Minotaur expansion appears under three different names in checkouts.

2.3 Connect the journey

The three queries that connect traffic to sales across the catalog.

Query 1: Products with sales but mysterious origins. Products with sales rows but no referral traffic matching their slug.

```
SELECT dp.product_id, dp.product_title, dp.product_slug, ss.net_items_sold, ss.total_sales
FROM dim_product dp
INNER JOIN shopify_sales ss ON dp.product_id = ss.product_id
LEFT JOIN referrals r ON r.landing_page LIKE '%' || dp.product_slug || '%'
WHERE r.landing_page IS NULL
ORDER BY ss.total_sales DESC;
```

Query 2: Products with traffic but no sales. Traffic comes in, nobody buys.

```
[your query]
```

Query 3: The full story. Every product with `total_sales`, `total_pageviews`, and a pageviews-per-unit-sold ratio.

```
[your query]
```

What you found: *a short paragraph covering:*

- Which products had high traffic but no sales?
- Which products had sales you couldn't trace to a source?
- What's the most interesting finding?

  Query 1 found 68 of 116 products with sales but no matching referral traffic, and Query 2 found product pages with heavy traffic but no matching sales product. The top results on both lists are largely the same products, such as Dwellings of Eldervale Standard (133,771 pageviews), We're Doomed!, Expancity, and The Game of 49, which means most of these gaps come from slug mismatches between Shopify's page URLs and our generated slugs, not from products that truly fail to sell. My most interesting finding is that the store's single highest-traffic product page could not be linked to its sales by an automated join, so the products that matter most to Mike are currently the least connected in the data. For the 48 products that did match, pageviews per unit sold averaged about 126 but ranged widely, from It Dies With Me at roughly 889 views per sale, a possible underperformer worth investigating, down to near zero where only a stray pageview matched. Before we can trust these ratios, the slugs in dim_product need to be manually mapped to the real landing pages.

2.4 Product performance leaderboard

Query used:

```
SELECT
  RANK() OVER (ORDER BY SUM(total_sales) DESC) AS revenue_rank,
  product_title,
  SUM(net_items_sold) AS net_items_sold,
  ROUND(SUM(total_sales), 2) AS total_sales,
  ROUND(SUM(total_sales) / NULLIF(SUM(net_items_sold), 0), 2) AS aov
FROM shopify_sales
GROUP BY product_title
HAVING SUM(net_items_sold) > 0
ORDER BY total_sales DESC
LIMIT 25;
```

Your top 25 products by revenue, with total sales, net items sold, and AOV (average order value) for each. Add rows until you have 25.

Rank	Product	Total Sales	Net Items Sold	AOV
1	Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit	28190.64	396	71.19
2	Dwellings of Eldervale 2nd Edition: Standard	24342.13	237	102.71
3	We're Doomed!	3274.07	370	36.14
4	Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden Upgrade Treasure and Trove Tokens	5997.5	296	20.26
5	Expancity | Family Strategy City Building Game | 2-4 Players	5983.09	104	57.53
6	Dwellings of Eldervale - DELUXE Upgrade Kit	5529.72	98	56.43
7	MIXTAPE	5284.12	254	20.8
8	Klask (First Edition)	4939.05	95	51.99
9	Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur Mercenary Mini Expansion	3274.07	323	10.14
10	Dwellings of Eldervale - Shapeshifter Mercenary Mini Expansion	3139.39	310	10.13
11	Dwellings of Eldervale - Oracle Hex Tile	2776.77	392	7.08
12	We're Doomed: Meritocracy Expansion Pack | Party Game | 4-12 Players	2740.11	135	20.3
13	The Big Box of Magic	2466.01	59	41.8
14	Pocket Dungeon Quest	2310.77	95	24.32
15	Letter Tycoon: Mensa Select Word-Building Strategy Game for Families and Friends,	2266.66	90	25.19

	Ages 10+, 2-5 Players			
16	Sparkle*Kitty Nights | Party Game Pattern Recognition Card Games | 3-8 Players	2217.41	88	25.2
17	Dwellings of Eldervale - Exclusive Game Mat	2138.64	35	61.1
18	Suddenly Drunk's Box of Bad Ideas	1892.21	80	23.65
19	Hypothetically Fun	1891.15	84	22.51
20	Flick Wars: Deluxe Edition	1701.9	21	81.04
21	Keep Calm! | Hilarious Party Game for Friends and Family | Ideal for Game Night | Ages 17+, 3-8 Players	1616.22	66	24.49
22	Mansplaining | Family Party Card Game | 2+ Players	1460.12	57	25.62
23	The Game of 49 | Family Friendly Strategy Board Game | 2-5 Players	1418.49	97	14.62
24	Billionaire Banshee - Fun Party Game for Adults - Perfect Icebreaker for Social Gatherings, Great for Friends & Couples, 2-10 Players	1342.39	79	16.99
25	Trellis	1316.89	51	25.82

2.5 Reorder recommendation

For Mike's November 1 reorder commit, your call.

Summary: The catalog follows a long-tail shape. The top 10 products drive 62.7% of Shopify revenue, and six of them belong to the Dwellings of Eldervale family. The full Dwellings line (10

products) accounts for 47.6% of all Shopify revenue. The recommendation prioritizes those ten flagships for a heavy holiday print run, backs five mid-tier sellers (ranks 11–15, bringing coverage to 70.6% of revenue) with a modest reorder, and trims three non-performing titles from the Play2Read line. Traffic data was used only as context, because product pages matched for fewer than half the catalog, including none of the Dwellings line.

Print heavy: reorder confidently (about 10 products)

- **Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit** (#1, $28,190.64, 396 units, 17.7% of revenue). Why: It's the single biggest revenue line, so a holiday stockout here would be the most expensive miss in the catalog.
- **Dwellings of Eldervale 2nd Edition: Standard** (#2, $24,342.13, 237 units, $102.71 per unit). Why: It's the base game behind the add-ons that fill four more slots on this list, so it has to be stocked deeply for the whole family to sell.
- **We're Doomed!** (#3, $13,371.28, 370 units, $36.14 per unit). Why: It's the top non-Dwellings title, strong on both revenue and units at a giftable price.
- **Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden Upgrade Treasure and Trove Tokens** (#4, $5,997.50, 296 units). Why: It's a high-volume add-on that rides on base-game sales.
- **Expancity** (#5, $5,983.09, 104 units, $57.53 per unit). Why: It's a premium family strategy title with solid, steady demand.
- **Dwellings of Eldervale - DELUXE Upgrade Kit** (#6, $5,529.72, 98 units, $56.43 per unit). Why: It's the mid-priced upgrade path between Standard and LEGENDARY, so it captures buyers at a second price point.
- **MIXTAPE** (#7, $5,284.12, 254 units, $20.80 per unit). Why: It has strong volume at a gift-friendly price and the highest measured traffic in the catalog (34K pageviews).
- **Klask (First Edition)** (#8, $4,939.05, 95 units, $51.99 per unit). Why: It's a premium dexterity game with consistent sales at a high price per unit.
- **Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur Mercenary Mini Expansion** (#9, $3,274.07, 323 units, $10.14 per unit). Why: It's a low-cost, high-volume add-on that's easy to sell alongside the base game.
- **Dwellings of Eldervale - Shapeshifter Mercenary Mini Expansion** (#10, $3,139.39, 310 units, $10.13 per unit). Why: It follows the same pattern as the Minotaur, with nearly identical demand.

Print light: modest reorder (about 5 products)

- **Dwellings of Eldervale - Oracle Hex Tile** (#11, $2,776.77, 392 units, $7.08 per unit). Why: It has steady demand at a small price point, so a modest run covers it without tying up much cash.
- **We're Doomed: Meritocracy Expansion Pack** (#12, $2,740.11, 135 units). Why: It's an expansion that sells off the #3 title, so a modest run keeps it available for existing fans.
- **The Big Box of Magic** (#13, $2,466.01, 59 units, $41.80 per unit). Why: Volume is lower, but it earns a healthy price per unit and has measurable traffic (5,077 pageviews).

- **Pocket Dungeon Quest** (#14, $2,310.77, 95 units). Why: It's a solid mid-tier seller with 11.8K pageviews, which leaves room to grow conversion before scaling up the print.
- **Letter Tycoon** (#15, $2,266.66, 90 units). Why: It's a dependable family title one tier below the flagships.

Don't print: let it go (about 3 products)

- **Play2Read: Crazy Sounds** ($22.44, 2 units). Why: Two sales all period, the weakest game in the catalog. Skip until next year's review.
- **Play2Read: New York Minute** ($22.57, 2 units, 150 pageviews). Why: Only two sales despite measurable traffic, so people who find it aren't buying.
- **Play2Read: My Turn, My Turn** ($33.70, 3 units). Why: Three sales all period, the weakest of the line after Crazy Sounds and New York Minute. Skip until next year's review.

Project 3: Following the Money

3.1 Channel breakdown

Where did your Meta spend actually drive traffic? Where are customers coming from on their own?

Channel	Pageviews	Checkout sessions	Conversion rate	Spend	Cost per pageview	Cost per checkout session
Paid Social (Meta)	250,618	553	0.22%	$98,542.56	$0.3932	$178.2
Organic Search	219,555	1093	0.5%			
Direct	327,754	995	0.3%			
Community/Referral	7,887	20	0.25%			
Email	6,590	39	0.59%			
Other	4,910	24	0.49%			

Where Facebook traffic lands: the products Facebook visitors land on, next to what those products sold. Up to 15 products; add rows as needed.

Product	Facebook pageviews	Units sold	Revenue
MIXTAPE	15,752	254	$5,284.12
Suddenly Drunk: Sexy Expansion	9,806	66	$616.14
Suddenly Stoned	9,083	125	$1,234.18
Real Life Holiday Bingo	7,559	67	$702.06
Pocket Dungeon Quest	5,226	95	$2,310.77
Suddenly Drunk: Hardcore Expansion	2,731	59	$542.13
POOP: The Game	2,363	28	$264.78
Hypothetically Fun	2,233	84	$1,891.15
It Dies With Me	995	5	$133.06
Mobscenity	841	20	$210.7
Billionaire Banshee: Sexy Foil Pack	782	54	$135.71
Measurement Toolbox	594	120	$794.37
Aura	582	23	$581.4
Something Wicked	570	8	$199.47
Flick Wars: Deluxe Edition	565	21	$1,701.9

Key finding: Meta is the only channel Breaking Games pays for, and it converts the worst of any major channel. Its 250,618 pageviews reached checkout at just 0.22%, while Organic Search sent similar traffic (219,555 pageviews) for free and produced about twice the checkout sessions (1,093 vs. 553), a 0.50% rate. So the $98,542.56 in Meta spend bought traffic at about $0.39 per

pageview and $178 per checkout session, and that traffic was less likely to buy than visitors who found us on their own. The product view shows where that traffic went wrong: Facebook sent heavy traffic to low-earning party add-ons like Suddenly Drunk: Sexy Expansion (9,806 Facebook pageviews, $616 in revenue) and Real Life Holiday Bingo (7,559 pageviews, $702), while products like Measurement Toolbox sold 120 units on just 594 Facebook pageviews. Community traffic is small but more efficient: BoardGameGeek alone converts at about 1.7× Meta's rate on about 68× less traffic. For Q4, that suggests pointing Meta ads at proven sellers instead of add-ons, testing community partnerships, and growing email, which converted best at 0.59%. All of this is directional, because we can't link a visit to a completed order, and units sold reflect all channels, not just Facebook buyers.

3.2 Meta campaign ROI

Top 5 best-performing campaigns (from Query 1; fewer than five is fine if your query returns fewer)

Campaign	Spend	Results	Cost per result
*DA | Traffic | Landing Page View	$12,807.08	71,327.0	$0.18
DA | MAT Test | Dwellings | Traffic - LPV	$4,344.57	17,753.0	$0.24
DA | MAT Test | We're Doomed | Traffic - LPV	$1,386.31	3,540.0	$0.39
*DA | Traffic | Engaged Page View	$2,346.86	795.0	$2.95
DA | Reach | Retargeting	$4,274.33	1,403,650.0	$3.05

Bottom 5: the ones to question (from Query 4; fewer than five is fine)

Campaign	Spend	Results	Cost per result	Why we should reconsider

DA | Sales	$16,601.66	NULL	—	Largest spend with no objective and no results recorded, so there's nothing to show for $16.6K
DA | Sales | ATC	$5,267.53	NULL	—	No results recorded despite the best CTR in the account (4.86%). Reuse the creative, but fix the setup before rerunning
*DA | Sales | MoF | Non Dynamic | Product Specific	$1,595.44	13.0	$122.73	Over 100 per purchase, about twice the cost of the main purchase campaign ($59.84)
* DA | Sales | Advantage Plus | Restock Only	$748.76	6.0	$124.79	Over $100 per purchase on very low volume
*DA | Sales | All Games	$441.06	1.0	$441.06	$441 for a single purchase, plus the highest CPC in the account ($5.65)

3.3 Q4 ad allocation plan

The short version: your top picks per bucket and the money math. The detailed version, with every campaign and its full reason, goes in a new tab of this document.

Keep

- *** DA | Sales | Advantage Plus | MoF | Dynamic.** Why: It's the account's main purchase engine, with 658 purchases at $59.84 each and a 1.94% CTR. Keep it running at its current budget.

- ***DA | Sales | Warm | Catalog.** Why: It's proven at $61.52 per purchase (106 purchases) with a 2.88% CTR, the second-best in the account. It's off now; restart it for the holidays.
- ***DA | Traffic | Engaged Page View.** Why: It's active and cheap at $2.95 per engaged view with a 2.18% CTR, a low-cost way to warm up new visitors for retargeting.

Cut ($24,654.45 freed up)

- **DA | Sales.** Why: $16,601.66 spent with no objective and no results recorded, the largest spend in the account with nothing to show for it.
- **DA | Sales | ATC.** Why: $5,267.53 spent with no results recorded. Its 4.86% CTR creative is the best in the account, so reuse the creative and drop the setup.
- ***DA | Sales | MoF | Non Dynamic | Product Specific.** Why: $122.73 per purchase (13 purchases), about twice the main campaign's $59.84.
- * **DA | Sales | Advantage Plus | Restock Only.** Why: $124.79 per purchase on only 6 purchases.
- ***DA | Sales | All Games.** Why: $441.06 for a single purchase, plus the highest cost per click in the account ($5.65).

New idea (where the freed dollars go)

- **BoardGameGeek / community holiday sponsorship ($10,000).** Why: BoardGameGeek converts at 0.38%, about 1.7× Meta's 0.22%, and reaches the hobbyists who buy Dwellings, our #1 revenue line.
- **Email list growth and holiday email flows ($7,500).** Why: Email & Owned Sites converts at 0.59%, the best of any channel and about 2.7× Meta.
- **A purchase-objective retest of the ATC creative, pointed at Dwellings and We're Doomed ($7,154.45).** Why: It puts our best-clicking ad behind our best-selling games, instead of the low-earning add-ons Facebook traffic currently lands on.

Money math: Not repeating five campaigns that spent $24,654.45 for either no recorded results or over $100 per purchase frees that full amount for email, BoardGameGeek, and a retest of our strongest creative, which are channels and products that already convert better than Meta traffic in our breakdown, so no new budget is needed.

Project 4: Investigating Breaking Games' Cart Abandonment

4.1 Where carts get abandoned

Top abandoned products (from your query): your top 10, with the carts-vs-orders gap.

Product	Carts (2016 onward)	Orders (August 2026)	Gap
Secret Hitler	78	0	78
Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit	70	5	65
We're Doomed!	68	0	68
Dwellings of Eldervale - Oracle Hex Tile	67	8	59
Sparkle*Kitty | Family-Friendly Pattern Recognition Card Games | 3-8 Players	65	3	62
Dwellings of Eldervale: MINOTAUR MINIATURE	45	0	45
Sparkle*Kitty Princess Palette Card	45	0	45
Rise of Tribes: The Mesa Hex Tile (Base Game Required)	42	0	42
Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden Upgrade Treasure and Trove Tokens	39	7	32

Dwellings of Eldervale: ALL EDITIONS - Legendary - $199.99	39	0	39

Caveats: The carts go back to 2016, but the orders only cover August 2026, so the gap compares years of cart interest to one month of sales and is not a conversion rate. The orders count is also too low for some products, because the join matches product names as exact text, and the same product is sometimes named differently in the two files (for example, “Dwellings of Eldervale: MINOTAUR MINIATURE” in carts vs. “Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur Mercenary Mini Expansion” in orders).

Time of day: Carts peak at midday, with 83 carts each at 12:00 and 13:00 (US Eastern), and there’s a smaller bump at 19:00. Overnight is quieter at 21 to 39 carts per hour, but that’s still higher than I’d expect for a mostly US store, especially the 3 to 6 AM range.

Day of week: Thursday has the most carts (192), and Wednesday (189) and Tuesday (187) are close behind. Saturday has the fewest (144). I expected hobby shoppers to browse more on weekends, so this is the opposite of what I thought I’d see.

Cart size: Most carts hold just one product: 980 of 1,197, or about 82%. Only a small number have three or more.

Discount usage: Only 90 of 1,197 carts (7.5%) used a discount code, and WELCOME10 was the most common one (31 carts). Discounts are barely being used to get people to finish checking out.

Geography: The US accounts for 596 of the 921 carts with a known country (65%). Canada (61), Germany (31), the UK (27), and Australia (22) come next. 276 carts never recorded a billing country at all.

What looks off: The first thing I noticed that looks off is a group of 23 carts from April to July 2025. Each one has exactly 6 units of a cheap party game like POOP, Suddenly Stoned, or MIXTAPE, a different email every time, no billing country, and timestamps at all hours of the day. I’ll investigate it as a bot/automation candidate in Step 3.

4.2 Bot/fraud detection criteria

Write your rules down before you count anything.

Rules I'm using:

1. lineitem_quantity > 5. A real customer rarely buys 6 or more copies of the same board game, so the whole cart gets excluded if any line goes over 5. This flagged 29 carts.

2. More than 5 carts on one email. A real shopper rarely starts 6 or more checkouts. This flagged one email (customer_1121) with 6 carts.

Trade-off: Rule 1 could catch a few real bulk buyers, like a game store or café stocking up. The four biggest carts (12, 10, 9, and 8 copies) all had a billing country, so some of them might be real resellers. Rule 2 could catch a very indecisive shopper, but the carts it flagged were all opened within about a minute of each other, so that doesn't seem to be the case here.

Rules I tested and rejected: Missing email and zero subtotal both matched 0 carts, so they wouldn't filter anything. Impossible geography (one email with more than one billing country) also never fired. I also left out a blank-subtotal rule, because a blank subtotal just means the row is the second or third item in a real multi-item cart. There are 382 of those rows, and that rule would have removed real customers.

Example carts (2 or 3 you flagged)

Cart	**What's in it**	**Why it looks like a bot**
#174745190401	12 GAME of PHONES (240) plus 12 of its expansion (60), $300 total	Nobody buys 12 copies of one party game to play at home.
#43389488005167 and #43417098911791	6 Poop: Brown Bag Combo each, $120 per cart	25 of the 29 flagged carts stop at exactly 6 units, which looks like a script with a set limit. Neither of these carts has a billing country.
customer_1121 (6 carts, #46371010707503 through #46371014049839)	1 Rise of Tribes: The Mesa Hex Tile in each cart	All 6 carts were opened between 05:27:30 and 05:28:33 on August 15, 2026, which is 63 seconds total for the same item.

4.3 The real abandonment rate

Metric	**Value**
Unfinished checkout sessions in the checkout file (2016 onward)	1,197
Completed orders (August 2026, from shopify_orders)	92

Naive abandonment rate (mismatched windows)	92.3%
Carts flagged as suspicious (your criteria)	35
Adjusted abandonment rate (August 2026, clean carts)	26.4%

Project 5: Building Breaking Games' Holiday Dashboard

5.1 The five numbers

Put a ★ next to your custom KPI.

#	KPI	Value	What it tells the team
1	Total Revenue	$159,612	This is the baseline for Q4 targets, and every other number on the page gets measured against it.
2	Meta vs. Organic Search Conversion	0.22% vs. 0.50%	Our only paid channel converts at less than half the rate of free search, so some Q4 ad money should move to channels that actually turn visitors into buyers.
3	Meta Ad Spend	$98,543	Without this number, no campaign recommendation can be judged because there's nothing to measure the return against.
4	Cart Abandonment (Adjusted)	26.4% (naive 92.3%)	Checkout isn't broken. The scary number came from mismatched dates and bot carts, so Q4 effort

			should go into fixable causes like shipping.
5	Top Product Share of Revenue	17.7%	Almost a fifth of revenue comes from one product, the Dwellings of Eldervale LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit, so it's the item we can least afford to run out of before Black Friday.

How you built them (after you build dashboard_metrics):

1. **Your CREATE statements:**
    a. dashboard_metrics is a table because the abandonment rate and the conversion numbers each need joins and subqueries, and the dashboard should read finished numbers instead of recalculating them every time.
    b. dashboard_leaderboard is a table because it's a fixed top 10 snapshot that the page reads as is, with no joins at load time.
    c. dashboard_channels is a **view**, because it's a small, fast summary that should always reflect the current referral data and my dim_referrer channels. It filters out the Bot / Suspicious channel so only real traffic reaches the chart.

```
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS dashboard_metrics;

CREATE TABLE dashboard_metrics AS
SELECT
  (SELECT ROUND(SUM(total_sales), 2) FROM shopify_sales) AS total_revenue,
  (SELECT ROUND(100.0 * SUM(r.checkout_sessions) / SUM(r.pageviews), 2)
   FROM referrals r
   JOIN dim_referrer dr ON dr.referrer = COALESCE(NULLIF(r.referrer, ''), 'direct')
   WHERE dr.channel = 'Paid Social (Meta)') AS meta_conversion_pct,
  (SELECT ROUND(100.0 * SUM(r.checkout_sessions) / SUM(r.pageviews), 2)
   FROM referrals r
   JOIN dim_referrer dr ON dr.referrer = COALESCE(NULLIF(r.referrer, ''), 'direct')
   WHERE dr.channel = 'Organic Search') AS organic_conversion_pct,
  (SELECT ROUND(SUM(spend_usd), 2) FROM meta_campaigns) AS total_meta_spend,
  ROUND(100.0 *
    (SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT name) FROM clean_checkouts
     WHERE substr(created_at, 1, 7) = '2026-08') /
    ((SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT name) FROM clean_checkouts
      WHERE substr(created_at, 1, 7) = '2026-08') +
     (SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT order_name) FROM shopify_orders)), 1) AS
real_abandonment_pct,
```

```
  ROUND(100.0 *
    (SELECT MAX(total_sales) FROM shopify_sales) /
    (SELECT SUM(total_sales) FROM shopify_sales), 1) AS top_product_pct;

DROP TABLE IF EXISTS dashboard_leaderboard;

CREATE TABLE dashboard_leaderboard AS
SELECT product_title,
    total_sales,
    net_items_sold,
    ROUND(total_sales / net_items_sold, 2) AS aov
FROM shopify_sales
ORDER BY total_sales DESC
LIMIT 10;

DROP VIEW IF EXISTS dashboard_channels;

CREATE VIEW dashboard_channels AS
SELECT dr.channel,
    SUM(r.pageviews) AS pageviews
FROM referrals r
JOIN dim_referrer dr ON COALESCE(NULLIF(r.referrer, ''), 'direct') = dr.referrer
WHERE dr.channel <> 'Bot / Suspicious'
GROUP BY dr.channel
ORDER BY pageviews DESC;
```

2. **The result of `SELECT * FROM dashboard_metrics;`**

	total_revenue	meta_conversion_pct	organic_conversion_pct	total_meta_spend	real_abandonment_pct	top_product_pct
1	159612.11	0.22	0.5	98542.56	26.4	17.7

3. **Refresh note:** I built these numbers on November 10, 2026. To rebuild them, re-run the three CREATE statements above in order and press Write Changes.
4. **Why these five:** I kept Total Revenue and Meta Ad Spend because they give the other numbers context. One shows what came in, the other shows what went out on ads. Each is paired with a number that explains it: Top Product Share shows where the revenue comes from, and the Meta vs. Organic conversion gap shows whether the ad money was worth it. My ★ custom KPI is that conversion gap. Meta traffic reached checkout 0.22% of the time compared with 0.50% for free search, which tells Mike some of the Q4 ad budget should move. The adjusted abandonment rate stands on its own, since it replaces a 92.3% figure that would have sent the team chasing the wrong problem. I left out Units Sold because it mostly repeats revenue and doesn't change a decision. My computed column is AOV in the leaderboard, so the dashboard never has to calculate it.

5.2 Key findings (three to five)

Each one: one sentence for the finding, one sentence for the "so what."

1. **Finding:** The top 10 products bring in 62.7% of Shopify revenue, and the Dwellings of Eldervale line alone brings in 47.6%, from a $102.71 base game down to $7.08 add-on tiles. **So what:** Q4 reorders should lean toward the top 10 and the Dwellings family instead of being spread across all 116 products, though relying this much on one game is a risk to keep an eye on.
2. **Finding:** Meta sent 30% of all site traffic but converted at 0.22%, while Organic Search sent similar traffic for free and converted at 0.50%. **So what:** Some of the Q4 ad budget should move to channels that convert better, like email (0.59%) and BoardGameGeek.
3. **Finding:** Five Meta campaigns spent $24,654.45 and either recorded no results or cost more than $100 per purchase. **So what:** If we don't run them again, that money can fund the Q4 plan without asking for any new budget.
4. **Finding:** The 92.3% cart abandonment rate drops to 26.4% once dates are matched and bots are removed; among the carts that remain, international shoppers face $35.80 in shipping on average, about 75% of what's in their cart. **So what:** Checkout isn't the emergency it looked like, so the team should go after specific fixes instead of rebuilding it.
5. **Finding:** International carts pay $35.80 in shipping on average, about 75% of what's in the cart. US carts under $25 pay about 54% of their value in shipping, and US carts from $25 to $50 pay about 30%. **So what:** Showing shipping estimates earlier and adding a US free-shipping threshold around $50 are cheap fixes aimed at the most likely real reason people leave.

5.3 The dashboard

*Paste a screenshot of your final HTML dashboard here. (Open **dashboard.html** in a browser, take a screenshot, drag it in.)*

Breaking Games: Holiday Game Plan

Prepared by: **Selena Chik** | Date: **November 10, 2026**

$159,612
TOTAL REVENUE (SHOPIFY SALES EXPORT)

0.22%
vs. 0.50% organic
★ META VS. ORGANIC SEARCH CONVERSION

$98,543
META AD SPEND

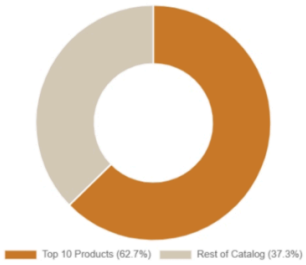
26.4%
CART ABANDONMENT (ADJUSTED; NAIVE 92.3%)

17.7%
TOP PRODUCT SHARE OF REVENUE

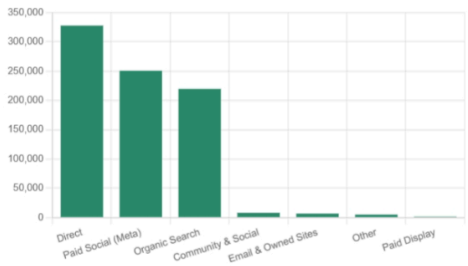
Top 10 Products by Revenue

#	PRODUCT	REVENUE	UNITS	AOV
1	Dwellings of Eldervale - LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit	$28,190.64	396	$71.19
2	Dwellings of Eldervale 2nd Edition: Standard	$24,342.13	237	$102.71
3	We're Doomed!	$13,371.28	370	$36.14
4	Dwellings of Eldervale - Wooden Upgrade Treasure and Trove Tokens	$5,997.50	296	$20.26
5	Expancity | Family Strategy City Building Game | 2-4 Players	$5,983.09	104	$57.53
6	Dwellings of Eldervale - DELUXE Upgrade Kit	$5,529.72	98	$56.43
7	MIXTAPE	$5,284.12	254	$20.80
8	Klask (First Edition)	$4,939.05	95	$51.99
9	Dwellings of Eldervale - Minotaur Mercenary Mini Expansion	$3,274.07	323	$10.14
10	Dwellings of Eldervale - Shapeshifter Mercenary Mini Expansion	$3,139.39	310	$10.13

Revenue Distribution (Top 10 vs Rest)



Traffic by Channel



Key Findings

The top 10 products bring in 62.7% of Shopify revenue and the Dwellings of Eldervale line alone brings in 47.6%.

Meta sent 30% of site traffic but converted at 0.22%, less than half of the 0.50% rate of free Organic Search traffic.

The 92.3% cart abandonment rate drops to 26.4% once dates are matched and bots are removed. High shipping costs are the most likely real cause.

Recommendations

1. Print heavy on the top 10 products above, led by the Dwellings of Eldervale family, and keep the base game deeply stocked so its add-ons can sell.
2. Stop repeating five Meta campaigns that spent $24,654 for no recorded results or over $100 per purchase, and move that money to email, BoardGameGeek, and a purchase-focused retest of our best ad.
3. Show shipping estimates earlier for international shoppers (average $35.80 per cart) and add a US free-shipping threshold around $50.

Built with the Breaking Games SQL & Database Architecture Externship.
Data current as of each export: Shopify orders through August 31, 2026; Meta through September 7, 2026; checkouts through October 6, 2026.

Link to your dashboard file:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1C3Wqfnh140cxXeeMeDB5c-fi3sob3zcO/view?usp=sharing

5.4 Speaker notes (optional)

For your 10-minute talk.

Headline: Meta, the only channel we pay for, sends lots of visitors but they reach checkout at less than half the rate of people who find us through search for free (0.22% vs. 0.50%). For Q4, that means some of the $98,543 we've been spending on Meta should move to channels that turn visitors into buyers.

Story: three findings. For each: the finding, what it means for Q4, and one limit.

1. **Finding:** The top 10 products bring in 62.7% of Shopify revenue, and the Dwellings of Eldervale line alone brings in 47.6%. **For Q4:** reorders should lean toward the top 10 and the Dwellings family instead of being spread across all 116 products. **Limit:** this is Shopify sales only, so products that sell mostly in stores, like POOP, look weaker here than they really are.
2. **Finding:** Meta brought in 30% of all site traffic but converted at 0.22%, compared with 0.50% for free search traffic. **For Q4:** the ad budget should be judged by who buys, not by how many people visit. **Limit:** there are no tracking tags, so I can't tie a visit to an order, and some Facebook traffic comes from free posts rather than paid ads.
3. **Finding:** The 92.3% cart abandonment rate drops to 26.4% once checkouts and orders are matched to the same month and 35 bot carts are removed. **For Q4:** checkout isn't broken, so the effort should go into specific friction like shipping, not a rebuild. **Limit:** it's based on one month of orders (August 2026), the only month the orders file covers.

Recommendations: three. For each: the action, the number behind it, what you expect to happen, and the pushback you expect.

1. **Action:** Print heavy on the top 10 products, led by the Dwellings family, and keep the base game well stocked so its add-ons keep selling. **Number:** top 10 = 62.7% of revenue; the LEGENDARY Upgrade Kit alone is 17.7%. **Expected:** fewer stockouts on the products that earn the most during Black Friday. **Pushback:** "What about games that sell well in stores?" My answer: this covers the website only, so I'd check wholesale numbers before cutting anything for good.
2. **Action:** Stop repeating five Meta campaigns that spent $24,654 for either no recorded results or more than $100 per purchase, and move that money to email, BoardGameGeek, and a purchase-focused retest of our best-clicking ad. **Number:** email converts at 0.59%, BoardGameGeek at 0.38%, and Meta at 0.22%. **Expected:** the same budget reaches people more likely to buy, with no new money needed. **Pushback:** "Meta says those campaigns drove sales." My answer: two of them recorded nothing at all, and the others cost $122 to

$441 per purchase compared with $60 for our main campaign, a gap too large for hidden purchases to close.

3. **Action:** Show shipping estimates earlier for international shoppers, and add a "you're $X away from free shipping" bar in the cart for the free shipping we already offer at $50. **Number:** international shipping averages about 75% of the cart's value, and 66 of 92 August orders came in under $50 and paid shipping. **Expected:** fewer surprises at checkout and more orders reaching $50. **Pushback:** "Can you prove shipping is why people leave?" My answer: no. The data shows high shipping is common among people who leave, not that it caused them to leave, so I'd run it as a test and track the share of orders over $50.

Pushback Q&A: [the hardest questions you expect, and your answers]

- **"Where did the 26.4% come from?"** It comes from clean_checkouts and shopify_orders. The filter is August 2026, the one month the orders table covers, with bot carts removed. I can pull up the query if that helps.
- **"What if your bot rules are wrong?"** Even if none of the six August carts I removed were bots, the rate would be 29.8%. That's still nowhere near 92.3%, so the conclusion doesn't change.
- **"What if Meta's conversion rate is off?"** Even if Meta's real rate were double what I measured, it would be 0.44%, still below organic search at 0.50%.
- **"Why is revenue lower than I expected?"** It's Shopify website sales only. Wholesale, conventions, and Kickstarter aren't in this data.
- **"What would change your mind?"** Tracking tags on our Meta links. If we could see which ad led to which order, some campaigns could move from cut to keep.

5.5 What you'd need next (optional)

If you had another four weeks, what data or analysis would unlock the most value?

With another four weeks, these would unlock the most value, in this order:

1. **Tracking (UTM) tags on every Meta ad link.** Right now I can only compare channels, not prove which ad led to which sale. This is free to set up, and it would let the next Q4 review judge campaigns by real purchases instead of estimates.
2. **Wholesale and store sales data.** The website is only one channel. Games like POOP and The Game of 49 may sell much better in stores, which could change the reprint list.
3. **Print cost per product.** Everything I measured is revenue, not profit. A $103 box and a $36 card game cost very different amounts to print, so margins could change which products are worth printing heavily.
4. **Dates in the sales and referral exports.** Without them, I can't confirm that sales and ad spend cover the same period, or see whether anything is trending up or down.

5. **Regularly saved checkout exports.** Shopify deletes abandoned checkouts after about three months, which is why there's a gap from August 2025 to June 2026. Saving an export each month would give a full year to compare.
6. **A cleaned-up product-to-URL mapping for the top 15 products.** The automatic slugs missed every Dwellings page, so even a small manual list would give real traffic and conversion numbers for the products that matter most.